Battle Among Regions: Official Rulebook (v4.0)

Welcome to the Battle

Battle Among Regions, where players act as generals leading their homelands in a war for supremacy. The objective is to outmaneuver your opponent with strategic command and military might by summoning units, casting spells, and taking control of powerful Landmarks. The four regions in the game are:

NORTH

WEST

EAST

SOUTH

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Content of Box

- 55 Eastern Cards
- 55 Northern Cards
- 55 Southern Cards
- 55 Western Cards
- 1 Round-counter-dice – D10 (1-10)
- 4 Mana-dice
- 4 Spell-mana-dice
- 12 Life point dices
- 90 Damage Counters
- 10 Silence tokens
- 21 Victory points
- 1 Rulebook

Part 1: Game Modes & Match Structure

1. Game Modes

There are three ways to play Battle Among Regions:

The War Campaign (Full game): A multi-game series where players earn Victory Points (VP) over three rounds. The player with the most VP at the end wins. This mode has a specific deckbuilding progression for each round.

Regional Match: The Regional Match is the suggested play-type for first-time gamers. Each player selects a box with a premade deck and plays with the corresponding deck. When you selected your region go to Part 2: The Rules of Battle

The Duel: Each player chooses a main region. A deck in a Duel contains 40 cards. Each player builds a custom deck, with a base from one region. If Duel is selected go to Part 2: The Rules of Battle.

1.1 The War Campaign

This is a multi-game series played over three rounds where the winner is the player with the most Victory Points (VP) at the end.

1.1.1 Two-Player Match Structure

- **Round 1**
  - **Deck:** Each player builds a 20-card deck with a minimum of 1 landmark from their own region. Players start by adding cards from their own region to their Deck. Place the 2 non-chosen Regions randomly between the players. Afterwards pass all your non-chosen cards to the region on your left and take the cards from the pile on your right. Now players can add cards from that region. Do this until both players have had all 4 regions and has 22 cards in deck.
  - **Landmarks:** Normal placement rules (See section *2. Rules of Battle: Game Setup***)**
  - **Life Points (LP):** 2000.
  - **Rewards:** The winner gets 1 VP and can place 1 Landmark in either player's Landmark zone at the start of round 2.
  - **Intermission 1:** Leave all Landmarks on the field for round 2. Players now add 10 cards to their deck. Use the same procedure as in the initial deckbuilding.
- **Round 2**
  - **Deck:** Players use their newly created 30-card decks.
  - **Landmarks:** Winner of previous round can place a landmark on the field in either player's Landmark zone. If the placed Landmark replaces another Landmark, that Landmark is sent to the graveyard.
  - **Life Points (LP):** 2500**.**
  - **Rewards:** The winner receives 1 VP and gets to places 1 Landmark in either player's Landmark zone at the start of Round 3.
  - **Intermission 2:** Leave all Landmarks on the field for round 3. Players add 10 cards from any region to their deck for a final deck size of 40 cards. Use the same procedure as in the initial deckbuilding.
- **Round 3**
  - **Deck:** Players use their 40-card decks
  - **Placement of landmarks:** Winner of previous round can place landmark on the field in either player Landmark zone. If the placed Landmark replaces another Landmark, that Landmark is sent to the graveyard.

- **Life Points (LP):** 3000.
- **Rewards:** The winner receives 1 VP.
- **Intermission 3:** If a player collected 3 VP, the game is won by that player. If not, leave all Landmarks on the field for round 4. Players can modify their 40-card decks by replacing up to 10 cards with new cards from any region. Landmarks must still be from players in their own region.

1.1.2 Three and Four-Player Match Structure

In these games, 2nd place is awarded to the last player eliminated.

- **Round 1: The Regional Skirmish**
  - **Deck:** Each player builds a 20-card with a minimum of 2 landmarks from their own region. Players start by adding cards from their own Region to their Deck. Afterwards pass all your non-chosen cards to the player on your left. Now players can add cards from that region. This continues until all players have 20 cards in deck. For 3-players: Place the non-chosen region between player 2 & 3, thereby the first Region, player 3 receives (after his own), is the non-chosen region.
  - **Placement of landmarks:** Normal placement rules (See section *2. Rules of Battle: Game Setup)*
  - **Life Points (LP):** 2000.
  - **Rewards:** The winner gets 2 VP and can pre-place up to 2 Landmark cards at the start of Round 2. 2nd place gets 1 VP and can pre-place 1 Landmark card at the start of Round 2. The player who "drew first blood" (eliminates the first player) also gets 1 VP.
  - **Intermission 1:** Bolstering Forces: Leave all Landmarks on the field for round 2. Players now add 10 cards to their deck. Players start by adding cards from their own region. Use the same procedure as initial deckbuilding. For 3-players: The non-choses region is placed where it ended after the initial deck-building.
- **Round 2: The Border War**
  - **Deck:** Players use their new 30-card decks.
  - **Placement of landmarks: pre-Awarded landmarks can now be placed on the field. 1st place, place 1 Landmark then 2nd place, place 1**

Landmark then 1st place, place their second Landmark. If the placed Landmark replaces another Landmark, that Landmark is sent to the graveyard.

- Life Points (LP): 2500.
- Rewards: The winner gets 2 VP and can pre-place 2 Landmark cards at the start of Round 3. 2nd place gets 1 VP and can choose to pre-place 1 Landmark card at the start of Round 3. The player who drew first blood also gets 1 VP.
- Intermission 2: All-Out War: Leave all Landmarks on the field for round 3. Players add 10 cards from any region to their deck for a final deck size of 40 cards. Players start by adding cards from their own region. Use the same procedure as initial deckbuilding. For 3-players: The non-choses region is placed where it ended after the initial deck-building.

- Round 3: The Final Front
  - Deck: Players use their final 40-card decks.
  - Placement of landmarks: pre-Awarded landmarks are now placed on the field. 1st place, place 1 Landmark, then 2nd place, place 1 Landmark, then 1st place, place their second Landmark. If a placed Landmark replaces another Landmark, that Landmark is sent to the graveyard.
  - Life Points (LP): 3000.
  - Rewards: The winner gets 2 VP. 2nd place gets 1 VP. The player who drew first blood also gets 1 VP.
  - Intermission 3: Conquest: Winner of the campaign is the player with the highest VP. If there is Tie, leave landmarks on the field and continue to round 4.
- Round 4: Tiebreaker: The War of Attrition
  - Deck: Players can modify their 40-card decks by replacing up to 10 cards in their deck with new cards. Players can only add landmarks from their own region
  - Placement of landmarks: pre-Awarded landmarks are now placed on the field. 1st place from the previous round, place 1 Landmark, then 2nd place, place 1 Landmark, then 1st place, place their second

Landmark. If a placed Landmark replaces another Landmark, that Landmark is sent to the graveyard.

- **Life Points (LP): 3000.**
- **Rewards: The winner gets 3 VP. 2nd place gets 1 VP. Winner of the campaign is the player with the highest VP. If the game results in another tie, play another tiebreaker round.**

Part 2: The Rules of Battle

2.1 Game Objective

The goal of a single game is to be the last player standing. You are eliminated if your Life Points (LP) reach 0 or if you must draw a card but your deck is empty.

Life points:

Regional match: 3000 LP

Duel: 3000 LP

2.2 Game setup

Give each player a 4-sided Spell-mana-dice and a 10-sided (0-9)-mana-dice

Place the 10-sided Round-Counter-dice on the center of the table.

Place the damage-calculators close to the game.

[Picture of Damage calculators]

Give each player 3 LP-dice. Use these to keep track of a player of LP. Set: Red Marble(d10) dice at 4, Black marble(d100) at 00, Black marble(d10) at 0: Combined showing 3000LP. When loosing or gaining LP adjust these, so they correspond your LP.

[Picture of dices]

If you play the campaign, use the Victory Points to keep track of score.

[Picture of VP]

Each player chooses a region to play.

Suggestion: Use a compass to determine what region you belong to. Closest to North gets the northern region and so on.

2.2.1 Deckbuilding

The War Campaign: Follow deckbuilding rules, described in 1.1 The War Campaign

Regional match: The regional match is played with the premade decks.

[Picture of deck]

Duel: Each player builds a deck containing 40 cards with a minimum of 2 Landmarks. A deck can only contain Landmarks from the chosen region.

2.2.2 Game setup continued

Landmark Placement: Before the game starts, each player may place 1 Landmark card from their deck directly into their Player Landmark Zone. In the War Campaign this Landmark placement is only for round 1. All other rounds follow the rules of the Pre-Awarded Landmarks.

Sort out any tokens from your deck and keep them close to the playing field.

Prepare to Play: Shuffle your deck, set your LP for the current game, and draw an opening hand.

LP for the Regional match and Duel is 3000. The

opening hand consists of:

Campaign - Round 1: 3 cards

Campaign - Round 2: 4 cards

Campaign - Round 3: 5 cards Regional

Match and Duel (2-players):

- Starting player 5 cards
- Second player 6 cards

Regional Match and Duel (3 or 4-players):

- Starting player 5 cards
- Second player 5 cards
- Third player 6 cards
- Fourth Player 6 cards

Opening Hand Mulligan: After drawing but before the first turn, each player may shuffle any number of cards from their hand into their deck and draw that same number of new cards. This is a one-time option per player.

2.3 Turn Sequence

The game is played in turns, each with the following phases:

Draw Phase:

If it's the starting players turn, turn the Round Counter in middle of table up by one.

Transfer up to 4 unspent mana from your d10 to your d4 for saved mana (see 2.4 The Mana System).

Set your mana for the turn (Turn 1 = 1, Turn 2 = 2, etc.) on your personal d10. Draw

1 card.

Main Phase 1: You may perform these actions in any order:

Play Unit Cards: Spend mana to play a Unit from your hand into an available Unit Zone. You can play it in face-up attack position (vertical) or face-up defense position (horizontal).

Play Spell Cards: Spend mana to play Spells from your hand face-up in the Spell/Trap Zone. You can also place spells face-down in the Spell/Trap zone without cost. The cost is spent when the spell is activated. You can't activate spells if you don't have the mana.

Set Trap Cards: You can Set Traps face-down in the Spell/Trap Zone without any cost. Traps cost is spent, when activated. You can't activate traps if you don't have enough mana.

Play Landmark Cards: Spend mana to play a Landmark into any Player Landmark Zone.

Activate Card Effects: Activate any card effects that can be used during your Main Phase.

Battle Phase: During this phase, the attacking player can declare attack with the units in attack position. Units can't attack and switch position in the same round. A unit can only attack once per turn. A unit can't attack the same turn it is summoned.

Declaring an attack: A player declares an attack with one unit at a time. When declaring an attack, the player must call what player and what unit they attack. This can't be changed afterwards. If the attacked player doesn't control a unit, the attack is targeted the players LifePoint'.

Reactions to an attack: After an attack is declared against a unit or a players' LifePoint, any player can choose to activate traps. If no traps are activated proceed to battle and damage calculation.

Main Phase 2: Same actions as Main Phase 1.

End Phase: Announce the end of your turn. If you have more than 8 cards in hand, you must discard x number of cards until you maximum 8 cards in hand.

2.4 The mana system

Gaining Mana: Each player starts the game with a 10-sided die (d10) set to 0. At the start of your turn, during the Draw Phase, you increase your mana by one more than the previous turn.

Place the round die in the middle of the table to keep count of what round you are in.

[Picture of round die]

Turn 1: Gain 1 Mana.

- If you play with 4 players, the 4th player starts turn 1, with 1 additional mana. In round 2, the 4th player gets 2 mana again (no additional mana).

Turn 2: Gain 2 Mana.

...and so on, up to a maximum of 9 mana gained per turn.

Spending Mana: All cards (Units, Spells, Traps, and Landmarks) have a Mana Cost. To play or activate a card, you must spend mana equal to its cost, turning your d10 down by that amount. You can play as many cards as you can afford during your turn.

Saving Mana: At the start of your turn, before gaining new mana, you can save up to 4 unspent mana from your previous turn. Saved mana is tracked on a 4-sided die (d4). This mana can only be used to play Spells, Traps, and Landmarks.

2.5 Battle & Damage Calculation

This section describes what happens after an attack is declared and all spell/trap effects has been applied and/or resolved. Use the damage-calculators to show the applied effects on the units. Damage on units is permanent and accumulates. A unit is destroyed if its total damage equals or exceeds its DEF.

Landmark Effects in Combat: When a unit declares an attack, only the effects of the Landmark controlled by the defending player are active for that specific battle. The attacking player's Landmark is considered inactive during the battle calculation. If the defending player does not have a Landmark, no Landmark effects are applied. Start any battle by applying the effects of the Landmark.

Damage calculation is determined based on the kind of attack. If a unit:

A. Attacks an Opponent's Life Points Directly: The opponent loses LP equal to the unit's ATK.

B. Attacks a Unit in Attack Position: Both the attacking and defending units deal damage to each other DEF equal to their ATK. If any of the unit's ATK exceed the DEF of the other unit, the exceeded damage is given to the LF of the owner of the destroyed monsters. Both players can lose LifePoints' during an attack.

C. Attacks a Unit in Defense Position: The defending unit takes damage but does not deal damage back. If the attacker's ATK is less than the defender's DEF, the attacker takes Rebound Damage, losing LP equal to the difference. E.g., If a unit has 300 ATK but the defender has 500 DEF. The attacking player lose 200 LP. After damage calculation the defending unit only has 200 DEF left for next attack.

2.6 Chain of unit-effects, spells and traps

Every time a card effect is activated, any player can play a card, if they have any cards which condition is met. If multiple effects are activated at the same time or related to the same event, the last activated effect is applied first.

2.7 The Field of Play

Each player has their own personal field with the following zones:

Unit Zone (5 slots): Where you place your Unit cards.

Spell & Trap Zone (5 slots): Where you place Spells and Traps.

Landmark Zone (1 slot per player): A dedicated zone for a Landmark. Landmark field is global, meaning that any player can play landmarks into any landmark zones.

Deck Zone & Graveyard: Your deck and discard pile¨.

2.8 Card Types

Units: The soldiers and creatures that fight for you. They have Attack (ATK), Defense (DEF), and a Cost, which is the number of mana you must spend to play the unit. Units from different regions has different colors. This is an Eastern unit:

Spells: Spells can be played at any time during a player's own turn. Spells are played by turning or placing them face-up in an available Spell & Trap Zone slot. Spells are removed from the field after the effect is resolved.

Traps: Cards that must be Set (placed face-down) in the Spell & Trap Zone, during a player's own turn. They cannot be activated the turn they are set. Traps are activated by turning them face-up, when their condition is met (if they have any). Traps are removed from the field after the effect is resolved.

Landmarks: Landmarks can be placed from hand into any players Landmark Zone during the active players Main Phase.

Tokens: Some cards allow to summon a token. A token is a unit, with all the same attributes as a normal unit. A token isn’t shuffled into your deck and

doesn’t count as 1 of your cards in deck. When the token-summoner card is played, find the token and place it on the field.

Part 3: Core Concepts & Glossary

3.1 Unit Keywords:

Some units have keywords printed on their card that grant them a special effect.

- Pierce: If this unit's ATK exceeds the remaining DEF of a Defense Position unit, the excess damage is dealt to the opponent's LP.
- Rush: Can attack the turn it is Summoned.
- Shadow: Can attack opponents life points directly, unless your opponent controls a unit with Shadow.

3.2 Glossary

- Activate: A card is activated, when it resolves without being negated.
- Adjacent: A card in a slot directly to the left or right of another card.
- ATK(Attack): The amount of damage a unit deals when it fights in attack-position.
- Destroy: Move a card from the field to the Graveyard.
- DEF(Defense): The amount of damage a unit can take before it is destoyed.
- Heal: Remove accumulated damage from a unit or restore Life Points. You can heal above your starting LP, but Units can't heal above their starting DEF.
- Mana: The mana you have on your Mana-dice (0-9)
- Negate: To stop a card or effect from resolving.
- Played: A card is considered played, when it is turned face-up.
- Round: A round is when all players have ended their turn.
- Silence: Negate all effects from a card and remove all ATK/DEF given to it.
- Spell mana: The mana shown on your Spell-mana-dice (1-4)
- Summon: To place a unit from your hand face-up in Attack or Defense Position.
- Total mana: You spell mana and mana combined.
- Turn: Refers to a players turn